UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2024

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time : 2 hours **(Exam date : 23.06.2024)** **Maximum Number : 200**

1. Consider the following statements:
Statement–I: There is instability and worsening security situation in the Sahel region.
Statement–II: There have been military takeovers/coups d'etat in several countries of the Sahel region in the recent past.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Ans.(a): Sahel region extended west to east in Africa which differentiate Sahara desert from south grasslands. In this region the expansion of Senegal, Mauritania, Mali, Burkina Faso, Niger, Nigeria, Chad, Sudan and Eritrea on the top of many conflicts, rising price and dwindling humanitarian change are creating additional serious stains. The area has also seen a high prevalence of coups (military takeovers) d'etat, currently ruling in Mali, over the last three years, the African Sahel region has witnessed a wave of coups d'etat in seven countries. In this reference we can say both I and II Statements are correct. Hence option A is correct.

2. Consider the following statements:
Statement-I: India does not import apples from the United States of America.
Statement-II: In India, the law prohibits the import of Genetically Modified food without then approval of the competent authority.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II in correct

Ans.(d): India imports apples from the USA. Indian law prohibits the import of genetically modified food without the approval of the competent authority.
• Import, of food products is regulated under the Food Safety and Standards Act (FSSAI), 2006. Indian Customs can clear food products including Genetically Modified (GM) food products only after obtaining approval NOC by FSSAI. The Food Safety and Standards Act of 2006 prohibits import, manufacture, use or sale of GM food without FSSAI's approval.

3. With reference to the Speaker of the Lok Sabha, consider the following statements:
While any resolution for the removal of the Speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration.
1. He/She shall not preside.
2. He/She shall not have the right to speak.
3. He/She shall not be entitled to vote on the resolution in the first instance.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans.(a): When any resolution for the removal of speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration, he/she can not preside at the sitting of Lok Sabha. However, he may be present in the house.
• When any resolution for the removal of speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration, he/she can speak and take part in the proceedings of the House.
• When any resolution for removal of speaker of the Lok Sabha is under consideration he is entitled to vote in the first instance and not in the case of an equality of votes.
Therefore Statement 2 and 3 is incorrect and statement 1 is the correct answer.

4. With reference to the Indian Parliament, consider the following statements:
1. A bill pending in the Lok Sabha lapses on its dissolution.
2. A bill passed by the Lok Sabha and pending in the Rajya Sabha lapses on the dissolution of the Lok Sabha.
3. A bill regard to which the President of India notified his/her intention to summon the Houses to a joint sitting lapses on the dissolution of the Lok Sabha.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 only

Ans.(b): When the Lok Sabha is dissolved a bill pending in the Lok Sabha lapses (whether originating in the Lok Sabha or transmitted to it by Rajya Sabha.)
• When the Lok Sabha is dissolved, a bill passed by the Lok Sabha but pending in the Rajya Sabha lapses.
• When the Lok Sabha is dissolved, a bill does not lapse if the President has notified the holding of a Joint sitting before the dissolution of Lok Sabha.
Hence Statement 1 and 2 is correct and Statement 3 is incorrect.

5. With reference to the Parliament of India, consider the following statements:
1. Prorogation of a House by the President of India does not require the advice of the Council of Ministers.
2. Prorogation of a House is generally done after the House is adjourned sine die but there is no bar to the President of India prorogating the House which is in session.
3. Dissolution of the Lok Sabha is done by the President of India who, save in exceptional circumstances, does so on the advice of the Council of Ministers.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 only

Ans.(c): Under Article 85 (2) of the Constitution, the President may from time to time prorogue Houses or either House of Parliament. Termination of a session of the House by an order from the President under the above constitutional provision is called 'Prorogation'. The president exercises this power of Prorogation of the houses only on the recommendation of the prime minister or the cabinet i.e. the Council of Ministers.

• Prorogation normally follows the adjournment of the sitting of the House sine die. The time lag between the adjournment of the house sine die and its prorogation is generally two to four days. However, the President can also prorogue the house while in session.
• The President of India can dissolve the Lok Sabha before the expiry of its term on the advice of the Union Council of ministers. Hence, statement 2 & 3 are correct.

6. Consider the following statements:
Statement-I: The European Parliament approved The Net-Zero Industry Act recently.
Statement-II: The European Union intends to achieve carbon neutrality by 2040 and therefore aims to develop all of its own clean technology by that time.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Ans.(c): The European Parliament has recently approved the Net-Zero Industry Act, to enhance net-zero technology production within the European Union.
• The European Union aims to be climate neutral by 2050 an economy with net-zero greenhouse gas emissions. It is part of the European Green deal and is a legally binding target.
• The Act sets a target for the European to produce 40% of its annual needs for the net-zero emitting technologies by 2030, base on national energy and climate plans that each state will have to develop. It also aims to achieve 15% of the global market value for such technologies. The act aims to ensure that the bloc produces 40% of its solar panels, wind turbines, heat pumps and other clean tech equipment by 2030.

7. Consider the following statements:
Statement-I: Recently, Venezuela has achieved a rapid recovery from its economic crisis and succeeded in preventing its people from fleeing/emigrating to other countries.
Statement-II: Venezuela has the world's largest oil reserves.
Which one of the following is correct in respect of the above statements?
(a) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct and Statement-II explains Statement-I
(b) Both Statement-I and Statement-II are correct, but Statement-II does not explain Statement-I
(c) Statement-I is correct, but Statement-II is incorrect
(d) Statement-I is incorrect, but Statement-II is correct

Ans.(d): The ongoing socioeconomic and political crisis in Venezuela is marked by hyperinflation, escalating starvation, disease, crime and mortality rates. This has resulted in massive emigration from the country. The situation is believed to be by far the worst economic crisis in Venezuela's history. According to the national Living Conditions survey by 2021- 94.5% of the population was living in poverty based on income out of this 76.6% lived in extreme poverty.
• Venezuela is currently the country with the largest proven oil reserves in the world, with an estimated 300 billion barrels of oil.

8. With reference to the Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme, consider the following statements:
1. To implement the scheme, the Central Government provides 100% funding.
2. Under the Scheme, Cadastral Maps are digitalized.
3. An initiative has been undertaken to transliterate the Records of Rights from local language to any of the languages recognized by the Constitution of India.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans.(d): Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme was revamped and converted as a central sector scheme with effect from 1st April, 2016 with 100% funding by the centre.
• The main components of the Programme are:
(i) Setting Up of Modern Record Room.
(ii) Survey/re- survey
(iii) Data entry/re-data entry
(iv) Digitization of cadastral maps/FMBs/Tippans
(v) DIL RMP Cell
(vi) PMU
(vii) Evaluation Studies, IEC and Training
(viii) Core GIS/Software Applications.
• One of the innovative initiatives under Digital India Land Records Modernization Programme is transliteration of land records in all languages of schedule VIII in all state/UTs. In order to address the problem of linguistic barriers in land governance, the Government with the technical support of Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) Pune, has undertaken an initiative to transliterate the Records of Rights available in local language to any of the 22 schedule VIII language of the Constitution.

9. With reference to the 'Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan', consider the following statements:
1. This scheme guarantees a minimum package of antenatal care services to women in their second and third trimesters of pregnancy and six months post-delivery health care service in any government health facility.
2. Under this scheme, private sector health care provides of certain specialities can volunteer to provide services at nearby government health facilities.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans.(b): The 'Pradhan Mantri Surakshit Matritva Abhiyan' has been launched by the ministry of Health & Family welfare, Government of India. The program aims to provide assured, comprehensive and quality antenatal care, free of cost, universally to all pregnant women.
• Under the campaign, a minimum package of antenatal care services is to be provided to the beneficiaries on the 9th day of every month in the 2nd and 3rd trimester of pregnancy. The services can be availed at Primary Health centers, community Health centers, Rural Hospitals, sub-District Hospital - District Hospital Medical college. However, the Scheme does not guarantee six months post-delivery care.
• The programme also invites active participation from private practitioners on a voluntary. Obstetricians physicians from private sector and retired Obstetrician Gynecologist (OB/GYN) specialists are encouraged to provide voluntary services at designated public health facilities on the 9th of every month.

10. With reference to the Pradhan Mantri Shram Yogi Maan-dhan (PM-SYM) Yojana, consider the following statements: